

Tonderai Matanga

Senior Front-End Developer

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SUMMARY

Senior Front-End Developer with 8+ years of experience building accessible, high-performance web experiences. Deep expertise in React, TypeScript, and Next.js (SSR/SSG), with a strong CMS theming background across WordPress (custom themes, hooks/filters, Gutenberg, ACF) and Drupal 8/9/10 (Twig). Proven record delivering WCAG 2.1-accessible, cross-browser UIs, improving Core Web Vitals through Lighthouse-driven optimisation (40%+ faster load times), integrating REST and GraphQL APIs, and shipping reusable component systems through Git-based CI/CD with automated testing.

CORE SKILLS

- **Front-End:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3/SASS, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap; working knowledge of Vue, Svelte, jQuery
- **CMS & Theming:** WordPress (custom themes, hooks/filters, Gutenberg/blocks, ACF), Drupal 8/9/10 (Twig theming, theme layer), PHP
- **API Integration:** REST APIs, GraphQL, AJAX, JSON, Postman
- **Accessibility & Performance:** WCAG 2.1, responsive design, cross-browser compatibility, Lighthouse, Core Web Vitals optimisation
- **Testing:** Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright
- **Tooling & Delivery:** Git (GitHub/GitLab), CI/CD (GitHub Actions, CircleCI, Vercel; exposure to Jenkins-style pipelines), Storybook, Chrome DevTools

EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Developer | Retail Capital (TymeBank) | Jul 2021 – Present

- Build and maintain customer-facing web apps with React, Next.js, and TypeScript, using SSR/SSG, dynamic routing, and SEO-driven delivery.
- Improved performance and Core Web Vitals by 40%+ (load times) through code-splitting, lazy loading, bundle analysis, and Lighthouse-driven optimisation.
- Shipped reusable component libraries (Tailwind CSS/Storybook) with designers and backend engineers to standardise UI across products.
- Integrate UI with REST and GraphQL services, implementing robust data-fetching and error-handling patterns for complex workflows.
- Deliver accessible, responsive UI to WCAG 2.1 with cross-browser testing and strong debugging practices.
- Set up and maintain automated tests (Jest/React Testing Library/Cypress) and GitHub Actions CI pipelines, reducing QA cycles and improving release confidence.

Front-End Developer | Bet.co.za | Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

- Revamped key betting platform surfaces with React and TypeScript, improving engagement and reducing feature delivery time through reusable components.
- Developed and maintained the custom WordPress theme for the platform blog (central.bet.co.za): PHP templates, hooks/filters, custom post types/taxonomies, and a performance-focused front end.
- Optimised blog templates for SEO and page speed (caching, asset optimisation, image/script loading strategies) with responsive, mobile-first layouts.
- Integrated front-end components with internal Bet-Tech services via REST APIs and AJAX; implemented analytics instrumentation and A/B testing support.

- Built JavaScript-driven UI features and interactive widgets (jQuery/AJAX where appropriate), ensuring cross-browser compatibility under high traffic.

Front-End Developer Intern | Webaholics Digital Agency | Sep 2017 – Aug 2019

- Delivered pixel-perfect, responsive marketing sites and landing pages for clients across industries under tight sprint timelines.
- Built and customised WordPress themes/plugins with clean PHP templating and reusable UI components (JavaScript, CSS/SASS, Bootstrap).
- Contributed to Drupal 8/9 site builds: Twig templating, theme preprocessing, and front-end component integration.
- Improved CMS content presentation (menus, blocks/regions, Views output styling) while maintaining accessibility and cross-browser quality.
- Worked in Git-based workflows with designers and stakeholders, translating wireframes into functional, performant interfaces.

SELECTED HIGHLIGHTS

- **Performance:** 40%+ faster load times on customer-facing apps through Lighthouse/Core Web Vitals optimisation at Retail Capital.
- **CMS delivery:** custom WordPress theme for central.bet.co.za — custom templates, hooks/filters, SEO, and performance.
- **Platform migration:** Retail Capital portal into the TymeBank ecosystem with API integration and UI standardisation.
- **Quality culture:** introduced automated testing and CI practices that improved release reliability and reduced QA cycles.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- BComm Honours in Business Administration (Logistics & Retail Management) — Midlands State University, Zimbabwe
- Meta Front-End Developer Certificate
- Google UX Design Professional Certificate
- Scrum Master Certification
- Additional coursework: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Accessibility, Performance, CI/CD (LinkedIn Learning)